METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Community Relations Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Community Relations Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Community Relations is a Key Issue in the Social Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on their management of local community relations and policies on human rights.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	**Community Relations**
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Operational disruptions or loss of market access due to community opposition.
- Loss of formal and social license to operate.
- Litigation by landowners and other affected parties.

Community Relations Key Issue score

The Community Relations Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Community Relations Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Community Relations Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

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Component	Sustainability Indicator
Community Relations Impact & Disturbance score	Commitment to refrain from operating in protected areas
	Conducts community impact assessment prior to settling in new areas
	Indigenous people policy
	Local community engagement approach
Community Relations Conflict & Human Rights score	Monitors the effectiveness of its human rights policy
	Employee training on human rights protection
	Ethical conduct policy covers contract security providers
	Human rights policy
	Violence and conflict policy
Community Relations Distribution of Benefits score	Local procurement policy
	Programs to support local communities

Community Relations Management score

The Community Relations Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice and 0 corresponding to lack of management. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Community Relations Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

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The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components:

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Community Relations Impact and Disturbance score

The Community Relations Impact and Disturbance score evaluates the company's initiatives to manage and minimize negative impacts on local and indigenous communities through policies, commitments, and structured engagement practices. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Commitment to refrain from operating in protected areas**

Definition: Indicates whether a company has made a commitment to avoid operating in high-conservation areas, such as World Heritage sites or areas of cultural significance.

- **Conducts community impact assessment prior to settling in new areas**

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Definition: Indicates whether a company conducts community impact assessments in line with the principles of Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) or whether there is any evidence of community engagement prior to developing in new areas.

- **Indigenous people policy**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has a policy to minimize community impacts on indigenous people and their traditional way of life.

- **Local community engagement approach**

Definition: Indicates whether a company's approach to local community engagement includes proactive programs, such as grievance reporting mechanisms and formal community engagement channels.

Community Relations Conflict and Human Rights score

The Community Relations Conflict and Human Rights score evaluates the company's initiatives to uphold human rights and avoid involvement in conflict through formal policies, employee training, and monitoring mechanisms. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Monitors the effectiveness of its human rights policy**

Definition: The extent of monitoring to measure the effectiveness of human rights policies, and whether the company commits to targets or reports progress against human rights targets.

- **Employee training on human rights protection**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has employee training programs on human rights.

- **Ethical conduct policy covers contract security providers**

Definition: Indicates whether a company has a formal business ethics policy that applies to contract security providers and whether that policy is supported by auditing to ensure compliance.

- **Human rights policy**

Definition: Indicates whether a company has adopted a formal human rights policy and whether that policy is aligned with the United Nations Declaration of Human Rights.

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- **Violence and conflict policy**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has a formal policy or informal commitment related to violence and conflict.

Community Relations Distribution of Benefits score

The Community Relations Distribution of Benefits score evaluates the company's initiatives to share economic benefits with local communities through procurement policies and community support programs. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Local procurement policy**

Definition: Indicates whether a company has a policy to support local suppliers or prioritize purchases that support local communities.

- **Programs to support local communities**

Definition: A company's investments in community projects (including local infrastructure, hospitals and education) and philanthropic programs to support local communities.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- Human rights controversies.
- Community impact controversies.
- Indigenous people's controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to the Controversies cases section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Community Relations Exposure score

The Community Relations Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business Segment Exposure score only. The Business Segment Exposure score is scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk.

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Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following data sources and methodologies are used in the Exposure score calculation:

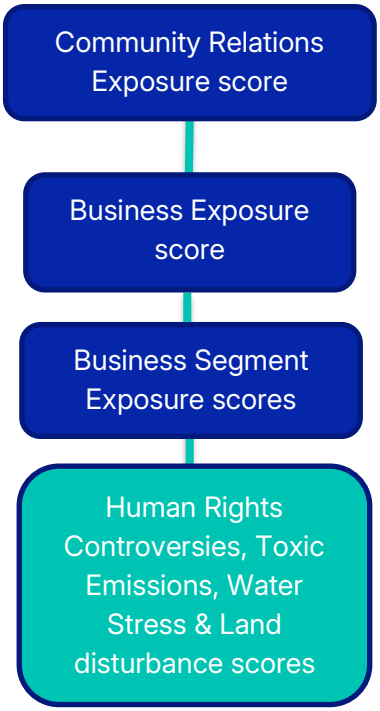
$$EXP_{CRE,i} = BUS_{CRE,i}$$

Where:

- $EXP_{CRE,i}$ is the Community Relations Exposure score of company i.

  $BUS_{CRE,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.

Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. Scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total assets in each business segment,[2] using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

[2] The percentage of assets is typically calculated as the company-reported asset value of the segment divided by the total asset value. In certain cases, industry-specific metrics are used to calculate the percentage of assets, such as power generation, production volume or reserve value. In cases where neither segment assets nor a relevant industry-specific proxy is available, the percentage is calculated based on segment revenue.

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$$BUS_{CRE,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Asset,i,j} BSE_{CRE,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{CRE,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Asset,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the the contribution to total company assets.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Business Segment Exposure score

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. Each Business Segment Exposure score is determined as follows:

$$BSE_{CRE,j} = \frac{HR_j + 0.5(LD_j + Max(WS_j, TE_j))}{2}$$

Where:

- HR_j is the Human Rights Controversies score for business activity j.
- LD_j is the Land Disturbance score for business activity j.
- WS_j is the Water Stress score for business activity j.
- TE_j is the Toxic Emissions score for business activity j.

The Human Rights Controversies score of a business activity is determined by the percentage of companies involved in a human rights-related controversy assessed as Moderate to Very Severe among all the companies with the same primary business activity.[3] Refer to Section: Controversies cases, of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for details on how the severity of controversy cases is assessed.

The Land Disturbance score of a business activity is derived from a qualitative assessment of each business activity and its land-use implications for community relations.

The Water Stress score of a business activity is derived from a component of the Water Stress Key Issue score, the Business Segment Exposure score on that Key Issue of a business activity. For details on how

[3] The primary business activity of a company is the industry, as defined by the SIC system, that is the largest contributor to its total assets.

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that score is calculated, see the Business Segment Exposure score section of "MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Water Stress Key Issue."

The Toxic Emissions score of a business activity is derived from a component of the Toxic Emissions & Waste Key Issue score, the Business Segment Exposure score on that Key Issue of a business activity. For details on how that score is calculated, see the Business Segment Exposure score section of "MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Toxic Emissions & Waste Key Issue."

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Community Relations Exposure score:

Environmental Protection Agency's (EPA's) Toxics Release Inventory, National Emissions Inventory, and Risk-Screening Environmental Indicators; U.S. Economic Census; The International Earth Rotation Service's (IERS), Comprehensive Environmental Data Archive (CEDA); water withdrawals per USD revenue compiled by MSCI S&C; M.M. Mekonnen and A.Y. Hoekstra, "The green, blue and grey water footprint of crops and derived crop products," Hydrology and Earth System Sciences 15, no. 5 (2011): 1,577-1,600; Refinitiv; MSCI S&C; company disclosures; Environmental Protection Agency (EPA).

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